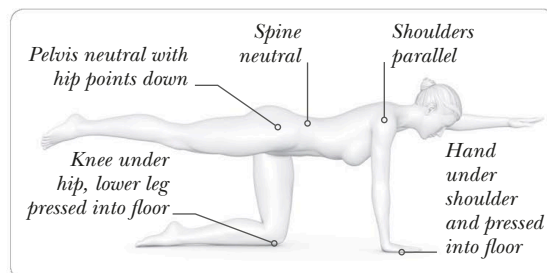


WARRIOR III

Virabhadrasana III

Warrior III is a strong, standing balancing pose that increases your focus and coordination. Your balance is particularly challenged as you bring your head parallel to the ground, affecting structures inside your inner ear that monitor your position and help to keep you upright.

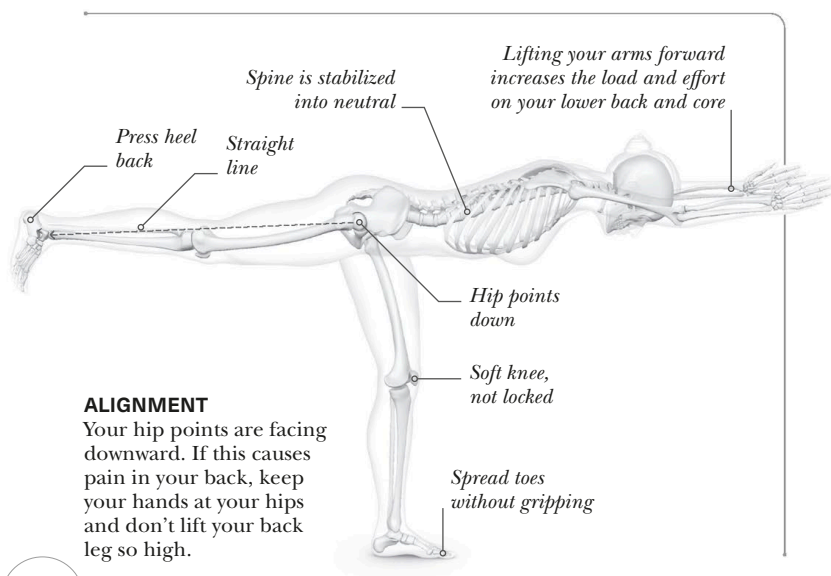
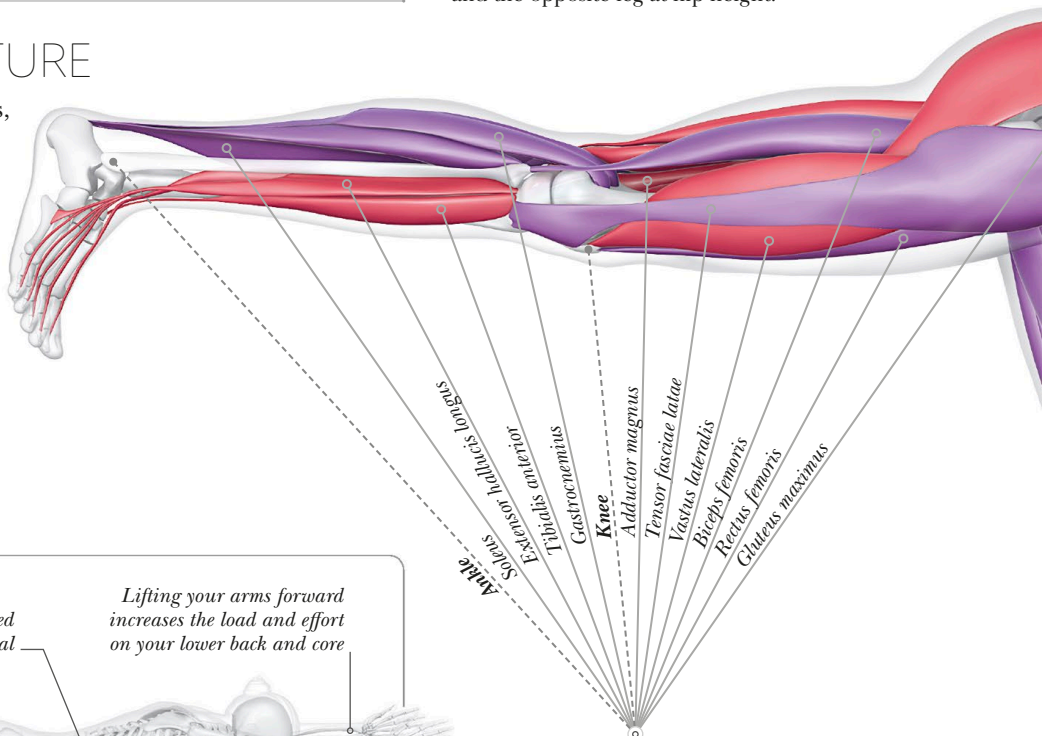


VARIATION

Sunbird challenges your balance but from a more stable base. Start on all fours, then lift an arm at shoulder height and the opposite leg at hip height.

THE BIG PICTURE

The muscles of your thighs, lower legs, and ankles strengthen as you try to maintain your balance on one leg. Muscles around your hips, core, and shoulders work hard to hold the rest of your body horizontal.



ALIGNMENT

Your hip points are facing downward. If this causes pain in your back, keep your hands at your hips and don't lift your back leg so high.

Lifted leg

Your **hip extensors** engage while your **hip flexors** stretch. Your **quadriceps** engage to extend your knee, while your **hamstrings** engage and lengthen. Push your heel back and feel your **ankle dorsiflexors** activate as though you are stepping firmly on a wall behind you. This helps your overall balance and stability.